Sara Alvarado

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Education

University of Washington Seattle, WA
Master of Science in Human-Centered Design and Engineering (HCDE) Sep 2024 – Jun 2026
Relevant Coursework: Designing for Accessibility, User-Centered Design, Usability Studies.

University of Southern California Los Angeles, CA
Bachelor of Art in Art and Design Aug 2020 – May 2024
Minor in Computer Programming
Cum Laude, Order of Troy Distinction
Relevant Coursework: Advanced Design Projects, Full-Stack Web Development, Tools for Digital Design.

Experience

Port of Seattle Seattle, WA
Web Accessibility Specialist May 2025 – Present
- Ensures Port of Seattle web content meets accessibility standards by testing WCAG 2.1 AA guidelines using industry-standard accessibility tools
- Reviews and remediates content in Drupal CMS for accessibility, including alt text, semantic HTML structure, and expected functionality for assistive technology and keyboard users
- Uses Microsoft Word and Excel to document compliance checks, create accessibility audit reports, and track remediation progress
- Contributes to the team's inclusive content strategy by conducting accessibility workshops and maintaining compliance documentation and resources

UW School of Medicine Service-Learning Program Seattle, WA
Frontend Developer Mar 2025 – Jun 2025
- Developed and maintained a Next.js and React-based web application, improving accessibility, performance, and user experience
- Translated Figma wireframes into responsive UI components, implementing modern UI/UX best practices
- Collaborated with designers and stakeholders, managed Git workflows and CI/CD pipelines, and proactively improved the platform weekly

UW Information Technology Seattle, WA
Web Accessibility Assistant Sep 2024 – May 2025
- Conducted accessibility testing on university websites using a variety of evaluation tools to ensure compliance with WCAG 2.1 standards
- Collaborated with developers and website owners to identify and implement accessibility improvements, utilizing WordPress, Drupal, and other content management systems
- Applied strong proficiency in HTML, CSS, and JavaScript to diagnose and resolve web accessibility issues, resulting in improvement in website usability for individuals with disabilities

USC Information Technology Program Los Angeles, CA
Teaching Assistant Aug 2022 – May 2024
- Led virtual office hours for ITP104: Web Publishing, ITP301: Front-End Web Development, and ITP304: Back-End Web Development by clarifying complex topics and answering questions
- Facilitated learning for over 50 students per semester by conducting weekly coding labs and offering hands-on support in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, PHP, and MySQL
- Assisted in grading assignments and exams, evaluating code quality, and identifying areas for improvement

Skills

Accessibility Testing: WCAG 2.2 (Level AA), WAI-ARIA, Desktop Screen Readers, Document Accessibility.
Technical: HTML/CSS, JavaScript, Drupal, WordPress, Figma.
UI/UX: Accessible Design, Usability Testing, Prototyping, Responsive Web Design, Graphic Design.